

and speed trumps quality and everything is chopped up and scaled down to meet deadlines. Sure they have a budget and big teams, but when the focus is on money rather than the end product, well, we all know how that turns out!

Indie games to the rescue! Thanks to crowdfunding and sites like Kickstarter, indie game developers actually have a platform to acquire funds. If you had a concept or idea that you thought was awesome, and felt like you could pull it off with some financial support, all you needed to do was pitch your idea to these crowdfunding sites. If the crowds felt your idea was worth backing, the money would roll in. This addressed one of the key problems when it came to indie games. Having a great idea and concept is all nice, but without the budget to be able to realise it, either you scrapped the thing entirely, or you were left with a sub-par game that was nowhere near what you initially had in mind. Of course this is not the case all the time, there are indie games out there that have become massively successful and have done so with minimal resources. Sure the game isn't big in the graphics department and it doesn't look hyper realistic, but if you're someone who plays games just for the visuals, hate to break it to ya but ya ain't a trueblue gamer.

The best part about indie game development is that they work very closely with their target audience. The ones who are funding their game are the ones who will play it, and game devs go out of their way to involve them. Indie game devs don't hide their development process, it's kept open and anyone is free to observe and even participate in some cases. Some indie devs actually stream the development process live on sites like Twitch. Backers can actively participate and suggest ideas to the team as they're working on building the game.

Since indie game devs aren't held down by restrictions they have the freedom to go about the development process as they wish. This is something that many AAA company developers crave. AAA companies are bound to their publishers, have limited distribution options and have to adhere to the

whims and fancies of their higher ups. Recent trends show many AAA company devs are actually leaving to form their own indie studios. In fact, many of the most anticipated indie releases coming up are being headed by veteran AAA developers who've gone indie. These guys aren't in it for the money, they want to make a great game, one that everyone can enjoy, and they want to do it their own way, without being held back by restrictions or any type of limitations.

So let's not waste any more time and take a look at some of the best Indie has had to offer, which could easily give AAA titles a run for their money.

The Binding of Isaac

So Isaac's mother starts hearing the voice of God and he's demanding a sacrifice. You know, to prove her faith and all that. The ideal candidate happens to be Isaac. Wait we've read this story somewhere before.. Never mind. Anyway, Isaac doesn't want to be sacrificed (duh), so he runs into the basement and hides there. But you know that feeling you had as a kid, like there were monsters or something in the basement?(most of us don't have basements though, awkward) Turns out it's all true. It's infested with monsters, lost brothers and sisters(who probably hid in the basement as well because; crazy mother), and his fears. Yes his fears. They're quite scary, you'd get it if you've played it.

The Binding of Isaac is an RPG shooter. It's got lots of rogue-like elements as well. You've got weird pickups that give you abilities to help you fight off the droves on monsters coming at you in the dungeon and there are over 300 levels! Who has a basement that's that huge?!

If we could think of one game this resembles off the top of our heads it



would be Legend of Zelda from the good old NES days.

Don't Starve

Don't starve comes from the same folks who brought us Shank and Mark of the Ninja, which were amazing 2D platformers in their own rights, so when we say they've outdone themselves with Don't Starve, we're giving them mad cred here.

Don't Starve falls under the action-adventure survival genre. All you need to do is survive. That's it. You're dropped into a randomly generated world and you're not given much to start with, not even instructions for that matter, so you're a tad lost at first. Be prepared to die, A LOT. But once you get the hang of it, it's quite addicting. The world is full to the brim with danger, everything here is out to kill you. You can gather items and there's an intricate crafting system to help you survive longer. You can build structures and such to help you in your endeavour as well, so if you've played games like say Minecraft, you'll feel right at home.

Spelunky

This daring spelunker(-er-er-er) will stop at nothing to get to the treasure, no matter what obstacles come in his way. Spelunky is a platformer – platformer games are aplenty in the indie category, so that makes it all the more worthwhile when a really good platformer shows up among the plethora.